

SUPERVISED VOCATIONAL QUALIFICATION DIPLOMA - EXAMINATION

Session: Revision Mock Set 04	Duration: 3 hours
Specialty: Psychotherapy	Coefficient: 04
Eliminatory mark: < 8/20	Training reference: VTI-AEDA examination style

COMPREHENSIVE VOCATIONAL PAPER PRACTICE SET 04

Revision material based on the supplied VTI-AEDA 2025 examination format and the supplied psychotherapy course recordings. Not an official examination paper.

PART ONE: PSYCHOPATHOLOGY

Section A: Multiple Choice Questions: Place a bold tick against the appropriate response option provided. (10mks)

1. During assessment, Joel reports after trauma, recurrent intrusions or nightmares, avoidance, negative changes in mood/cognition and heightened arousal persisting beyond one month. Which of the following is the BEST match?

- A. Post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD)
- B. Agoraphobia
- C. Schizophrenia
- D. Opioid intoxication

2. During assessment, Yvette reports at least two weeks of depressed mood and/or loss of interest with associated sleep, appetite, energy, concentration, guilt, psychomotor or suicidal symptoms. Which of the following is the BEST match?

- A. Social anxiety disorder
- B. Bipolar disorder
- C. Brief psychotic disorder
- D. Major depressive disorder

3. Lucas, a 58-year-old farmer, presents with abnormally elevated or irritable mood with increased energy, reduced need for sleep, pressured speech, grandiosity, racing thoughts and risky activity. Which diagnosis or clinical concept best fits this presentation?

- A. Autism spectrum disorder
- B. Manic episode
- C. Schizoid personality disorder
- D. Substance use disorder

4. Yvette, a 59-year-old mechanic, presents with a history of a manic episode, often alternating with periods of depression. Which diagnosis or clinical concept best fits this presentation?

- A. Bipolar disorder
- B. Obsessive-compulsive disorder (OCD)
- C. Manic episode
- D. Anorexia nervosa, binge-eating/purging type

5. Patricia, a 56-year-old teacher, presents with persistent psychotic illness with delusions, hallucinations and/or disorganized speech or behavior, often with social or occupational dysfunction. Which diagnosis or clinical concept best fits this presentation?

- A. Brief psychotic disorder
- B. Schizophrenia
- C. Autism spectrum disorder
- D. Opioid intoxication

6. A therapist notes that Hassan has sudden onset of delusions, hallucinations or disorganized speech/behavior lasting at least a day but less than a month, with return toward baseline. Which condition should be considered first from the options below?

- A. Brief psychotic disorder
 - B. Substance use disorder
 - C. Agoraphobia
 - D. Social anxiety disorder
7. During assessment, Esther reports significantly low body weight, intense fear of weight gain and restriction without recurrent binge-purge episodes. Which of the following is the BEST match?
- A. Obsessive-compulsive personality disorder (OCPD)
 - B. Generalized anxiety disorder (GAD)
 - C. Post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD)
 - D. Anorexia nervosa, restricting type
8. A therapist notes that Fidel has significantly low body weight with anorexia features plus recurrent binge-eating or purging. Which condition should be considered first from the options below?
- A. Stimulant intoxication
 - B. Bulimia nervosa
 - C. Anorexia nervosa, binge-eating/purging type
 - D. Agoraphobia
9. Grace, a 27-year-old teacher, presents with recurrent binge eating followed by compensatory behaviors such as vomiting, laxatives or excessive exercise, without the persistently low weight required for anorexia. Which diagnosis or clinical concept best fits this presentation?
- A. Anorexia nervosa, restricting type
 - B. Bulimia nervosa
 - C. Substance use disorder
 - D. Opioid intoxication
10. A therapist notes that Victor has recurrent binge eating with loss of control and distress but without regular compensatory purging or fasting. Which condition should be considered first from the options below?
- A. Obsessive-compulsive disorder (OCD)
 - B. Binge-eating disorder
 - C. Opioid intoxication
 - D. Borderline personality disorder

SECTION B: ANSWER TRUE OR FALSE (5mks)

- 1. PTSD is diagnosed solely because a frightening event occurred. TRUE / FALSE
- 2. Dependent personality disorder may involve difficulty making everyday decisions without reassurance. TRUE / FALSE
- 3. An opioid is more likely than a stimulant to produce drowsiness and physiologic slowing. TRUE / FALSE
- 4. A manic episode is simply a happy mood with no change in energy or functioning. TRUE / FALSE
- 5. Anorexia nervosa can include binge-eating/purging behavior if the person also meets the low-weight anorexia criteria. TRUE / FALSE

SECTION C: SHORT ESSAY (10mks)

- 1. Differentiate a panic attack from panic disorder. (2mks)
- 2. Differentiate obsession from compulsion and give one example of each. (2mks)
- 3. State the four D criteria commonly used when considering abnormality. (2mks)
- 4. Define substance use disorder in practical clinical terms. (2mks)
- 5. Give two reasons early intervention in substance use disorder is important. (2mks)

PART TWO: THEORIES/TECHNIQUES IN PSYCHOTHERAPY

Section A: Multiple Choice Questions: Place a bold tick against the appropriate response option provided. (15mks)

1. A therapist working with Tina uses an intervention characterized by an approach emphasizing freedom, responsibility, choice, meaning, authenticity, isolation and awareness of mortality. Which approach or technique is being used?
 - A. Countertransference
 - B. Free association
 - C. Existential therapy
 - D. Social skills training
2. A therapist working with Victor uses an intervention characterized by learning by association between stimuli so that a previously neutral cue comes to elicit a response. Which approach or technique is being used?
 - A. Classical conditioning
 - B. Countertransference
 - C. Systematic desensitization
 - D. Resistance
3. In a session with Yvette, the counselor emphasizes behavior is shaped by its consequences, including reinforcement and punishment. This BEST illustrates:
 - A. Adlerian therapy
 - B. Operant conditioning
 - C. Social modeling
 - D. In vivo exposure
4. Which psychotherapy concept is most accurately described by the following: a behavior increases because it removes or prevents an aversive stimulus?
 - A. Negative reinforcement
 - B. Progressive muscle relaxation
 - C. Resistance
 - D. Operant conditioning
5. Which psychotherapy concept is most accurately described by the following: a previously reinforced behavior decreases when the reinforcement maintaining it is consistently withheld?
 - A. Operant conditioning
 - B. Extinction
 - C. Classical conditioning
 - D. Gestalt dream work
6. A therapist working with Wendy uses an intervention characterized by learning behavior by observing what happens to another person or by imitating a model. Which approach or technique is being used?
 - A. Social skills training
 - B. Gestalt dream work
 - C. Countertransference
 - D. Social modeling
7. A therapist working with Owen uses an intervention characterized by planned contact with feared stimuli, memories or situations while reducing avoidance so fear can be relearned. Which approach or technique is being used?
 - A. Rational emotive imagery
 - B. Extinction
 - C. Flooding
 - D. Exposure therapy
8. In a session with Hassan, the counselor emphasizes direct, real-life exposure to a feared object or situation. This BEST illustrates:

- A. Classical conditioning
- B. Social modeling
- C. In vivo exposure
- D. Empty-chair technique

9. Which psychotherapy concept is most accurately described by the following: gradual exposure to a fear hierarchy combined with relaxation or another incompatible response?

- A. Systematic desensitization
- B. Transference
- C. Gestalt dream work
- D. Cognitive behavioral therapy (CBT)

10. In a session with Uma, the counselor emphasizes rapid and prolonged exposure to a high-intensity feared stimulus or situation without gradual hierarchy progression. This BEST illustrates:

- A. Social modeling
- B. Person-centered therapy
- C. Negative reinforcement
- D. Flooding

11. In a session with Grace, the counselor emphasizes systematically tensing and releasing muscle groups to learn physical relaxation and reduce arousal. This BEST illustrates:

- A. Operant conditioning
- B. Classical conditioning
- C. Cognitive behavioral therapy (CBT)
- D. Progressive muscle relaxation

12. A therapist working with Wendy uses an intervention characterized by a skills-based therapy especially associated with emotion dysregulation and borderline personality disorder, using mindfulness, distress tolerance, emotion regulation and interpersonal effectiveness. Which approach or technique is being used?

- A. Dialectical Behavior Therapy (DBT)
- B. Flooding
- C. Rational emotive imagery
- D. Transference

13. In a session with Xavier, the counselor emphasizes behavioral teaching and rehearsal of interpersonal skills such as greetings, eye contact, listening and conversation. This BEST illustrates:

- A. Rational emotive imagery
- B. Interpretation
- C. Social skills training
- D. Social modeling

14. A therapist working with Lucas uses an intervention characterized by the client says whatever thoughts, feelings, images or memories come to mind without censoring them. Which approach or technique is being used?

- A. Resistance
- B. Free association
- C. In vivo exposure
- D. Interpretation

15. Which psychotherapy concept is most accurately described by the following: the therapist explains or offers meaning about patterns, defenses, dreams, resistance or behavior?

- A. Classical conditioning
- B. Interpretation
- C. Social skills training

D. Dialectical Behavior Therapy (DBT)

SECTION B: ANSWER TRUE OR FALSE (5mks)

1. Progressive muscle relaxation involves systematically increasing tension and never releasing it. TRUE / FALSE
2. In vivo exposure occurs only in imagination. TRUE / FALSE
3. Retroflexion involves directing toward oneself an impulse that might otherwise be directed outward. TRUE / FALSE
4. Rational emotive imagery belongs to the REBT family of techniques. TRUE / FALSE
5. Social skills training can use modeling, role play, rehearsal and feedback. TRUE / FALSE

SECTION C: SHORT ESSAY (5mks)

1. State one technique specific to psychoanalytic work. (2mks)
2. Explain systematic desensitization in three steps. (2mks)
3. Distinguish flooding from graded exposure. (1mks)

PART THREE: PROFESSIONAL ORIENTATION AND ETHICAL/LEGAL ISSUES IN PSYCHOTHERAPY

Section A: Multiple Choice Questions: Place a bold tick against the appropriate response option provided. (15mks)

1. A counselor asks which principle or professional concept is defined by maintaining accurate, timely, secure and clinically appropriate client records. The BEST answer is:

- A. Record keeping
- B. Mandated reporting
- C. Boundary violation
- D. Gift decision-making

2. A counselor asks which principle or professional concept is defined by ending therapy responsibly with preparation, continuity planning and referral when needed rather than abandoning the client. The BEST answer is:

- A. Boundary crossing
- B. Termination and referral
- C. Boundary violation
- D. Bartering

3. A counselor asks which principle or professional concept is defined by using ethical codes, consultation/supervision and appropriate reporting procedures when credible serious misconduct is observed. The BEST answer is:

- A. Beneficence
- B. Informed consent
- C. Ethical response to colleague misconduct
- D. Termination and referral

4. A counselor asks which principle or professional concept is defined by protecting privacy, competence, informed consent, identity, emergency planning and data security when using digital or remote services. The BEST answer is:

- A. Termination and referral
- B. Technology ethics
- C. Beneficence
- D. Professional competence

5. A counselor asks which principle or professional concept is defined by not automatically disclosing the entire file on receipt of a subpoena; consult applicable law, the client/attorney and professional guidance, and disclose only as authorized or legally required. The BEST answer is:

- A. Sexual relationship with a current client
- B. Autonomy
- C. Subpoena response
- D. Ethical response to colleague misconduct

6. During supervision, Kemi describes respecting the client's right to make informed choices about treatment. Which concept should guide the discussion?

- A. Termination and referral
- B. Technology ethics
- C. Beneficence
- D. Autonomy

7. In professional practice, a situation calls for acting to promote the client's welfare and benefit. Which ethical/legal concept is MOST directly involved?

- A. Duty to warn/protect
- B. Beneficence
- C. Professional competence
- D. Mandated reporting

- 8.** A counselor asks which principle or professional concept is defined by avoiding or minimizing harm. The BEST answer is:
- A. Professional competence
 - B. Nonmaleficence
 - C. Boundary crossing
 - D. Justice
- 9.** During supervision, Zachary describes fair and equitable distribution of services, benefits, burdens and opportunities. Which concept should guide the discussion?
- A. Boundary crossing
 - B. Fidelity
 - C. Gift decision-making
 - D. Justice
- 10.** A counselor asks which principle or professional concept is defined by truthfulness and honest communication with clients. The BEST answer is:
- A. Subpoena response
 - B. Ethical response to colleague misconduct
 - C. Veracity
 - D. Boundary crossing
- 11.** During supervision, Patricia describes keeping commitments, maintaining trust and being faithful to professional responsibilities. Which concept should guide the discussion?
- A. Informed consent
 - B. Bartering
 - C. Gift decision-making
 - D. Fidelity
- 12.** A counselor asks which principle or professional concept is defined by an ongoing process in which the client receives understandable information about services, risks, benefits, alternatives, limits of confidentiality and choice. The BEST answer is:
- A. Professional competence
 - B. Subpoena response
 - C. Duty to warn/protect
 - D. Informed consent
- 13.** A counselor asks which principle or professional concept is defined by the professional duty to protect information learned in the therapeutic relationship, subject to recognized legal and ethical exceptions. The BEST answer is:
- A. Boundary violation
 - B. Confidentiality
 - C. Autonomy
 - D. Professional competence
- 14.** A counselor asks which principle or professional concept is defined by the client's broader right to control access to self, body and personal information. The BEST answer is:
- A. Nonmaleficence
 - B. Boundary violation
 - C. Duty to warn/protect
 - D. Privacy
- 15.** In professional practice, a situation calls for a legal protection that may prevent compelled disclosure of certain therapy communications in judicial proceedings, depending on jurisdiction. Which ethical/legal concept is MOST directly involved?
- A. Privileged communication
 - B. Boundary violation
 - C. Justice

D. Technology ethics

SECTION B: ANSWER THE FOLLOWING QUESTIONS CORRECTLY (5mks)

1. Define malpractice. **(2mks)**
2. Give two elements of informed consent. **(1mks)**
3. When is termination ethically appropriate? **(1mks)**
4. State one key ethical requirement for clinical records. **(1mks)**

SECTION C: SHORT ESSAY (5mks)

1. Why are dual relationships ethically risky? **(2mks)**
2. What is a boundary violation? **(2mks)**
3. State two technology-related ethical concerns in teletherapy. **(1mks)**

PART FOUR: CULTURAL DIVERSITY / GROUP THERAPY / COUNSELING PROCESS / TREATMENT PLAN IN PSYCHOTHERAPY

Section A: Multiple Choice Questions: Place a bold tick against the appropriate response option provided. (15mks)

1. Which counseling/group/cultural concept is BEST described by: systematically exploring the client's problems, symptoms, context, history, strengths, risk and functioning?
 - A. Storming stage
 - B. Norming stage
 - C. Termination and follow-up
 - D. Assessment
2. In counseling practice, Wendy encounters a situation involving collaboratively defining client-centered outcomes that are realistic and observable. Which concept BEST applies?
 - A. Goal setting
 - B. Adjourning stage
 - C. Group confidentiality
 - D. Skills-development group
3. Which counseling/group/cultural concept is BEST described by: implementing agreed therapeutic strategies and monitoring the client's response?
 - A. Termination and follow-up
 - B. Active listening
 - C. Performing stage
 - D. Intervention stage
4. Which counseling/group/cultural concept is BEST described by: reviewing progress, consolidating coping skills, planning relapse prevention or referral and ending the professional relationship responsibly?
 - A. Assessment
 - B. Cultural imposition
 - C. Performing stage
 - D. Termination and follow-up
5. In counseling practice, Kemi encounters a situation involving attending closely to verbal and nonverbal communication and showing the client that the message has been heard and understood. Which concept BEST applies?
 - A. Active listening
 - B. Assessment
 - C. Open-ended questioning
 - D. Therapeutic confrontation
6. In counseling practice, Wendy encounters a situation involving identifying and feeding back the emotional meaning expressed by the client. Which concept BEST applies?
 - A. Psychoeducational group
 - B. Active listening
 - C. Paraphrasing
 - D. Reflection of feeling
7. A trainee observes restating the essence of the client's content in fresh words without changing its meaning. This is an example of:
 - A. Paraphrasing
 - B. Case formulation
 - C. Performing stage
 - D. Self-disclosure
8. Which counseling/group/cultural concept is BEST described by: questions that invite elaboration rather than a yes/no answer?

- A. Open-ended questioning
- B. Assessment
- C. Paraphrasing
- D. Forming stage

9. In counseling practice, Hassan encounters a situation involving respectfully pointing out discrepancies between a client's words, behaviors, values or nonverbal cues. Which concept BEST applies?

- A. Group role
- B. Therapeutic confrontation
- C. Case formulation
- D. Paraphrasing

10. Which counseling/group/cultural concept is BEST described by: the therapist deliberately shares limited personal information when it is likely to benefit the client rather than meet the therapist's own needs?

- A. Reflection of feeling
- B. Self-disclosure
- C. Active listening
- D. Cognitive-behavioral group

11. A trainee observes a collaborative written or explicit plan linking identified problems to goals, measurable objectives, interventions and review. This is an example of:

- A. Performing stage
- B. Cognitive-behavioral group
- C. Treatment plan
- D. Skills-development group

12. A trainee observes an organized explanation linking the client's presenting problems with relevant history, triggers, maintaining factors, strengths and a rationale for intervention. This is an example of:

- A. Case formulation
- B. Adjourning stage
- C. Termination and follow-up
- D. Therapeutic confrontation

13. A trainee observes evaluating whether objectives are being achieved and modifying the treatment plan when progress is absent, circumstances change or goals are met. This is an example of:

- A. Cultural imposition
- B. Group role
- C. Progress review
- D. Ethnocentrism

14. In counseling practice, Uma encounters a situation involving ongoing development of awareness, cultural knowledge, clinical skills and meaningful encounters with diverse clients. Which concept BEST applies?

- A. Assessment
- B. Cultural competence
- C. Active listening
- D. Cognitive-behavioral group

15. In counseling practice, Patricia encounters a situation involving judging other cultures primarily by the standards of one's own culture and treating one's own as the norm. Which concept BEST applies?

- A. Group role
- B. Therapeutic confrontation
- C. Ethnocentrism
- D. Group confidentiality

SECTION B: SHORT ESSAY (10mks)

1. What is case formulation? **(4mks)**
2. Describe the storming and norming stages of group development. **(4mks)**
3. Give four examples of counseling skills used in an intake session. **(2mks)**

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SIMULATION OF REAL WORKING SITUATION PAPER PRACTICE SET 04

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SECTION I

1. Emotion dysregulation and self-harm

Clara, 19, describes rapidly shifting intense relationships, fear of abandonment, impulsive spending, recurrent self-cutting and episodes of overwhelming anger followed by shame.

What therapeutic model is particularly relevant? Demonstrate the priorities and skills you would introduce. (25mks)

2. Authority, guilt and independence

Emmanuel, 26, grew up in a strict family and school environment. he automatically seeks approval from authority figures, feels guilty when disagreeing, and wants to make independent adult choices but fears rejection and moral failure.

Choose an anchor therapeutic approach and demonstrate a session that addresses choice, responsibility, values and assertiveness. (25mks)

SECTION II

1. Retirement and loss of meaning

After retiring from a long career, Fatou, 33, says, "Without my work I do not know who I am." she has become socially withdrawn, anxious about aging and preoccupied with whether life still has purpose.

Demonstrate an existentially oriented session while also assessing for depression and risk. (25mks)

2. Irrational beliefs and self-worth

After a relationship breakup, George, 40, repeatedly says, "I absolutely must be loved by everyone. If someone rejects me, it proves I am worthless and I cannot stand it."

Use REBT to formulate and intervene in this case. Demonstrate the ABCDE model. (25mks)